

Core Features of Regeneron ISEF Judging

Judging at the Regeneron International Science and Engineering Fair is different from what you have experienced at other science fairs. While, as usual, judges review project displays, interview students, and determine awards, the way in which those processes operate *in toto* is unique to ISEF. Here are some of the important features of ISEF that you should understand before arriving at the fair. Documents elsewhere on the *Judge Information Board* will explain each feature in further detail.

1. Scheduled Interviews

Each interview of a project will occur during one of 20 scheduled 15-minute periods on Wednesday. At registration on Tuesday afternoon, each judge will be assigned an initial set of 13 interviews during the first 18 periods. On Wednesday afternoon, a second set of two scheduled interviews will be assigned for periods 19 and 20.

2. “My5” Projects

While viewing project displays on Tuesday, judges can indicate up to five projects that they would like to interview, but were not assigned. The schedule for periods 19 and 20 will utilize each judge’s “My5” projects to the maximum extent possible.

3. Unscheduled Interviews

In addition to the 15 scheduled interviews above, each judge can choose to interview and score up to two other projects during their unscheduled periods on Wednesday.

4. Scores

For all interviews above, judges will determine scores on a 0-100 scale and submit them electronically throughout the day on Wednesday. These scores are highly processed before being presented to the caucuses.

5. Award Decisions

After the last of the interviews, judges will caucus with each other to discuss candidate projects and select all award winners. A graphical analysis of interview scores will inform these award decisions, but *does not determine them*.

Point of Emphasis

Grand Award judges will score projects through three different sets of interviews:

1. The initial set of 13 interviews assigned at Registration for periods 1-18,
2. Optionally, up to two more *unscheduled* interviews during breaks in periods 1-18, and
3. A final set of two scheduled interviews during periods 19-20 assigned Wednesday afternoon based upon each judge’s “My5” preferences.